SOEN 341 – Software Process

CareerConnect

Generative AI Usage Log

Student	Philip Ear
Project	CareerConnect – Job Search and Application Tracking Platform
Sprint	Sprint 2
Primary Work	Feature 2 frontend – Job Search and Job Listing Interface; Feature 3 – Job Application Submission and Tracking
Log Updated	October 26, 2026

1. Purpose of This Log

This document records my Sprint 2 work on CareerConnect and my use of ChatGPT during the later implementation steps. My Feature 2 responsibility was the frontend Job Search and Job Listing Interface: displaying opportunities, searching and filtering jobs, and showing detailed job descriptions. The later Feature 3 work covered job application submission and tracking across the frontend and backend.

The detailed AI entries record the purpose of each interaction, the suggested content, the available validation, the decision, and the relevant prompt evidence. The implementation record also identifies the code changes associated with my Feature 2 work.

2. Summary of Work and AI Usage

Record	Task / Purpose	Area	Evidence
F2.1	Job details and navigation	Frontend	Code commits
F2.2	Loading, empty, and error states	Frontend testing	Code commits
F2.3	Keyword search, filters, and no results	Frontend	Code commits
F3.1	Application submission and tracking	Frontend / backend	Chat screenshot
AI 1	Correct the shared stylesheet	Frontend debugging	Exact prompt + file
AI 2	Identify the next testing steps	Testing guidance	Exact prompt + screenshot

Scope of the Sprint 2 Work

Feature 2 was frontend work built around the jobs API. It included the Jobs page, search and filter controls, the Job Details page, and interface states. The Feature 3 conversation describes additional database and backend endpoint work together with the Apply Now form, My Applications page, and navigation. Taken together, the later work spans both frontend and backend.

3. Sprint 2 Implementation Record

Feature 2 – Job Search and Job Listing Interface

My frontend work covered displaying available job opportunities, searching and filtering by keyword, location, or category, and allowing users to open detailed job descriptions.

Work	Implementation and evidence
Job details	Added the Job Details page, a job-details route, View Details navigation, and related styles. The later update displays job metadata, description, requirements, and a Back to Jobs link. Evidence: commits 7d54ee2 (October 22) and 6d6bebe (October 26).
Loading and error states	Added Jobs page tests for the loading message, an empty jobs response, and a failed request with a Try again button. Evidence: commit 29a2b42 (October 22), Jobs.test.jsx. The saved tests establish test coverage; this log does not record a new test run.
Search and filtering	Completed frontend keyword matching and location/category filters. The page combines the selected criteria and provides a Clear search action when no jobs match. Evidence: commits 10e18cf (October 22) and 6d6bebe (October 26), Jobs.jsx and styles.css.

Feature 3 – Job Application Submission and Tracking

The October 26 chat screenshot records the database, backend endpoints, Apply Now form, My Applications page, and navigation as implemented. The visible editor includes ApplyForm.jsx, MyApplications.jsx, AppLayout.jsx, JobDetails.jsx, App.jsx, and styles.css on the feature/job-application-submission branch.

The same screenshot shows the Jobs interface with job cards and misplaced View Details buttons. This provides the context for the later request to edit the shared stylesheet. The AI then identified testing as the next step before committing the feature.

Responsible Person: Philip Ear

Conversation: CareerConnect System Design, October 26, 2026.

4. Detailed AI Usage Entries

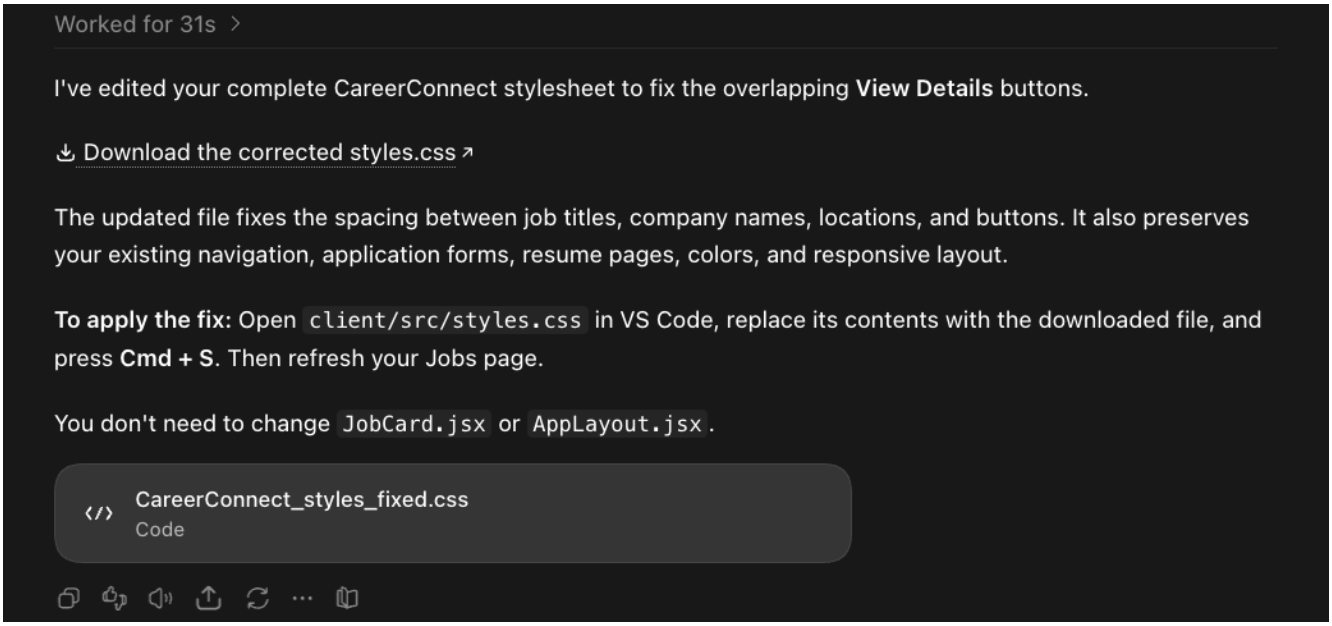
Entry 1 – Correct the Frontend Stylesheet

Task ID / Title	Feature 3 integration – shared frontend styling
Purpose	Ask ChatGPT to edit the existing stylesheet after a layout problem appeared in the CareerConnect interface.
AI-Suggested Content	Earlier advice visible in my supplied screenshot was to correct styles.css while keeping the existing navigation and application routes. I later supplied the shared stylesheet, including job-list, job-details, search, and filter styles, for direct editing.
Validation	I provided a screenshot showing the interface and later attached the stylesheet for direct editing. The screenshot records my earlier message "Perfect, It's working great now" and shows job cards with misplaced View Details buttons. It documents the layout context before the direct-edit request.
Decision	Requested a direct edit to the supplied stylesheet.
Reflection	The shared stylesheet affects several pages. A visible layout problem needs to be checked against the actual component classes and existing navigation before further changes are made.
Responsible Person	Philip Ear

Evidence: Appendix A.1 – prompt and attached file.

Prompt: "Redo the complete .css file so I can learn from it"

Attachment:



Earlier AI advice visible in the screenshot: "You only need to correct styles.css. Your navigation and application routes can stay exactly as they are."

The attached screenshot also records the AI identifying the database, backend endpoints, Apply Now form, My Applications page, and navigation as implemented for Feature 3.

Entry 2 – Request the Next Step for Feature 3

Task ID / Title	Feature 3 – testing before committing
Purpose	Ask for the next step after the application feature and layout work.
AI-Suggested Content	Earlier guidance visible in the supplied screenshot recommends testing before committing to GitHub. It provides frontend test and build commands and recommends manually checking submission and the My Applications page. This is the context for the later next-step prompt.
Validation	The screenshot shows the development frontend and backend running. It does not show a completed test run, a successful production build, or the result of submitting an application.
Decision	Requested the next step after the implementation work.
Reflection	Seeing the pages in development is one check. Application submission and tracking also need a complete flow through the interface, backend, and database.
Responsible Person	Philip Ear

Evidence: Appendix A.2 – exact follow-up prompt and visible testing guidance.

Prompt: "What are the next steps?"

Earlier AI advice visible in the screenshot: "The next step is to test the feature before committing it to GitHub."

The testing guidance visible in the screenshot includes:

```
cd client
npm test -- --run
npm run build
```

The visible manual check is to apply for a job and confirm that the application appears under My Applications.

Appendix A.3 – Follow Up on Work Scope

Exact prompt: "I'm trying to understand, but the work I did today includes only backend or both?"

This prompt asks whether the work covered the backend only or the full stack. Feature 2 was my frontend responsibility; the Feature 3 implementation described above includes frontend and backend components.

Today, you worked on **full-stack development**, not just backend.

You implemented both the **backend and frontend** of Feature 3 — Job Application Submission and Tracking — for CareerConnect.

Area	What you worked on
Backend	Created the `applications` database table in SQLite
Backend	Created `applications.js` with API endpoints for submitting and retrieving applications
Backend	Added JWT authentication and duplicate-application prevention
Frontend	Created `ApplyForm.jsx` with an Apply Now button and resume selection
Frontend	Created `MyApplications.jsx` to display submitted applications and statuses
Frontend	Updated `JobDetails.jsx` to include the application form
Frontend	Updated `App.jsx` and `AppLayout.jsx` for application routes and navigation
Frontend	Fixed CSS styling and overlapping job buttons